



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 17

KANSAS

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Kansas's family courts and child-welfare system.

272

KANSAS FAMILIES ON RECORD · 496
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 16 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING
TIME

REPORT GENERATED

AUGUST 14, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED

65 OF 105

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · KANSAS

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Kansas. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Andrew Bolton

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE / OTHER · MIAMI · 15 SUBMISSIONS

"Has not spoken to anyone I asked him to speak to, including people whom are in direct contact with my children in school. Set a separate hearing in regards to his fees not being paid, which I had paid 50% of his fees. Refused to speak with me in person. Told me he always meets the first time via Zoom. I attempted to reach out to him after our Zoom call and was told that all future communications would be dealt with between attorneys."

LINN COUNTY

"Hand-picked by Judge Richard Fisher. Refuses to review my evidence. Believes all allegations against me. Won't allow me to choose my own reintegration therapist — required to use his buddy Naomi Catadella. I lost my kids to the REAL abuser and Andy Bolton and Richard Fisher painted me as crazy, took my voice."

"The system allowed my abuser to escape all consequences to the point of his criminal charges being dismissed and helped Dad turning me into the abuser. The system has stripped me of any belief that leaving my abuser was the right choice. I wish I would have stayed — at least I would still have my children."

"Gave 50/50 custody to my ex, that my children have said sexually assaulted them (went through due process and just because she was a scared 3 year old and wouldn't tell forensic investigators they deemed it unfounded) Bolton still gave father 50/50 and recommended co parenting therapy."

"Ignored evidence. Did not investigate. Sided with bias due to ex communicating and me going through my lawyer. Literally yelled at me in court, misconduct and the judge even called him out." FRANKLIN

"GAL. Did nothing. Was a puppet for the case manager. Kept trying to get off our case and was finally dismissed by the judge."

"Accused me of being wrong for being in an abusive relationship and didn't talk to any witnesses I provided."

"Didn't interview witnesses or children involved. Was aggressive towards us, yelling."

"Placed children into foster care refused to talk to them"

"Lied under oath about child's wants." MIAMI COUNTY

"Real life con artist" JOHNSON

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ks-andrew-bolton/complaint-packet>

Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Naomi Cataudella**REUNIFICATION THERAPIST · JOHNSON · **11 SUBMISSIONS**

"She refused to let me have a pen and paper. She took my phone so I could not make notes. She was the first supervisor assigned to me after my children were taken on January 29, 2024. During our meetings, she gave me constantly shifting and conflicting rules about how I was allowed to behave. I was told I could not cry in front of my children—even though they had just been taken from me without the chance to say goodbye—and that if I did, they would be removed from the visit and I would not be allowed to see them again for two weeks. She denied ever saying those things, despite having clearly stated them before. Without warning, she told me she would no longer serve as my supervisor. I left that meeting in tears, completely broken. That moment was not just an isolated incident—it was the beginning of a pattern that has kept me separated from my children for over two years."

"Absolutely the worst person of the case. I believe she has been given some unexplainable reign over the court system and went on a power trip. Maybe she had one successful case and was since considered an "expert"? However, no one kept that in check. Not only did she destroy me emotionally and mentally, but she did so to my children as well. We've all needed therapy to help us recover from HER. She has flat lied in court reports. She has flat out caused more chaos and "high-conflict" than was originally even there. Unfortunately, I am too scared of what she can still do with my case if I say more. I'm sorry for everyone that has to deal with her. If she is recommended to you by anyone in the court system, absolutely object and RUN."

"We had to see her, pay \$170 each time, for her to yell and tell us we were messing our kids up by not getting along. We didn't get along because my ex husband would lie, call CPS on me which never amounted to anything, she would tell me how awful we were. I literally had to sit with my abuser in a room with her & listen to her tell me I wasn't fair."

"She believed every single lie from the father in my case because he was charming in sessions. She allowed the father a thousand delays and excuses and was brutally harsh on me. She would say she hates working with us. She would give horrible stares downs. She was rude and unprofessional near every session. She never solved our issues."

"Reintegration therapist forced on me by Andy Bolton — described as Bolton's buddy. Located 2.5 hours away from my home. I was required to use her, not allowed to choose my own."

"She gave me 1 hour and then issued a report to my detriment. Never saw me with our kids. In my opinion is part of a corrupt system used in Johnson County KS."

"Complete waste of time. Nothing accomplished. 2 years going almost weekly to Naomi. No progress."

"She manipulated me with our GAL and said things that were my true."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ks-naomi-cataudella/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Bethany Roberts

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · OSAGE · 8 SUBMISSIONS

"This lady is oblivious to evidence, psychology, and anything relevant to a "child's best interest". What a disgrace to family law...period. She has allowed numerous court ordered violations, that literally show the mental issues with the other parent, which were discussed and she literally tried to make me the perpetrator. That was the end of it for me, I have gone 100% gray rock for all the people involved except the child. I really hoped for one non-corrupt person in all this, but I literally found none other than my own attorney at the time."

"Never met with the primary custodial parent of 12 years nor was that parent given the opportunity to submit evidence. She knew no one in the hallway when we finally got a hearing after the children were removed. She didn't know the children's teachers, coaches or counselors. She even attempted to intimidate a witness in the hallway, the school counselor. She then recommended the children and family to see a therapist that was not properly licensed."

"Spoke to me for only 15 minutes. Made a court recommendation based on this single 15 minutes conversation. Never spoke to my child, and was seen in quiet conversation with my ex's new wife in the court room during a recess. I am fairly convinced that Bethany and ex's wife are somehow related."

"Bethany Roberts failed to properly investigate my concerns, dismissed allegations of abuse without meaningful inquiry, and accepted my abuser's denials at face value, which further harmed and divided my family."

"Ignored and still ignores drug/alcohol abuse and neglect. Refuses to communicate with children's therapist regarding children's welfare"

"Ignored evidence, no communication, increased custody to harmful parent, sealed report/unable to review what lead to outcomes"

DOUGLAS AND SHAWNEE COUNTY

"Wrongful reporting, dismissal of evidence"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ks-bethany-roberts/complaint-packet>

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Keven O'Grady

JUDGE · JOHNSON · 8 SUBMISSIONS

"My child was drowning in a river and Judge O'Grady just stood there and watched while coldly eating a fresh baked pretzel from the mall across the street. I said "Judge O'Grady! Please do something!" And he looked at me, chuckled, and said "Sana, Sana, colita de rana.""

"Ignored evidence. Made me pay for supervised visits for my ex who attempted suicide in front of my 5 year old. Ignored evidence. Didn't question false statement from custody evaluator"

"The court system has taken away my son's mother, my other kids' brother. Kevin O'Grady needs to be exposed — he claims he does things for the kids' safety. No, he breaks families."

"Doesn't do shit. Named alongside attorney Katie McClafflin and GAL Andrew Bolton in the conflict that "fucked us all up.""

"It has taken my life. Father alleging parental alienation versus actual emotional abuse and neglect of children by him."

"No Due Process and never looked at the evidence"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ks-keven-o-grady/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Randy McCalla

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · JOHNSON · 7 SUBMISSIONS

"This is the single biggest trauma of my life. Guardian Ad Litem are the biggest threat to the family court system and their power must be checked. Randy McCalla ambushed me in court in 2013 — a standard custody hearing — claiming my rights needed to be terminated due to parental alienation. He presented no evidence, and I left court shocked and without my kids. Randy didn't allow me to talk to my kids for 5 weeks. He told me in his office that he knew the judge personally as if to imply she would do whatever he wanted. The therapist Randy insisted on using shared an office with him."

"Caused permanent and irreparable harm to my children's mental and physical health as well as to my entire family. Blackmailed by Randy McCalla. Ex parte communication between attorneys and court appointed medical professionals. Falsified court hearings with custody-modifying orders when no hearing ever occurred."

"Randy McCalla, GAL in my custody case; ordered psychological evaluations, multiple interviews with children, but in my experience the findings/recommendations and children's concerns were disregarded, which escalated conflict and harmed family stability. He ignored years of documented abuse."

"Functioned more as an advocate for a third-party visitation claim than as a neutral representative for the child and did not submit a formal written GAL report."

"Biased information, speaks with other party and not me. Has only spoken with children once."

"Let's personal opinion guide decisions"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ks-randy-mccalla/complaint-packet>

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Heather Landon

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · JOHNSON · 6 SUBMISSIONS

"Misled court regarding information gained about children's relationship to mother and maternal family. Failed to perform proper investigation or talk to material witnesses listed as required state procedure for GALs. Failed to disclose conflict of interest with judge. Previous history in other county courts under other names."

"Shows extreme bias based on if she knows the parties representatives. Does not put the child first. Ignores abuse claims due to the personal relationship she has with council."

"Earlier GAL on the case. Continued to force the children into reintegration therapy even though the DA said it would taint the criminal case against the father." MIAMI

"Withdrew from case. Violated rights, handled issues for ex during hearings, failed to meet with children and me"

"Heard petitioners story in her law office and still was allowed to be the gal, conflict of interest"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ks-heather-landon/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Stephanie Goodenow**JUDGE · JOHNSON COUNTY · **6 SUBMISSIONS**

"Ignored the domestic violence, Ignored the abuse that happened to my daughter that was done by her father, whom had charges in the same county. Ignored evidence. Allowed the derailing. Ignored that I had been a victim of domestic violence and all abuse done by the father many years and much more."

"She wouldn't listen to me or my attorneys about the abuse, drugs, disregarded everything. Told me it was "almost legal" in Kansas when he was smoking & having drugs around our kids & told him to "put his stuff away". She has let him continue to break court orders with no repercussions."

"Inserted punitive orders against me without any evidence"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ks-stephanie-goodenow/complaint-packet>

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Catherine Decena TriplettJUDGE · JOHNSON · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

"Ignored all domestic violence. I hate Judge Triplett, Judge Sloan, and CASA. Abusive dad teamed up with my abusive parents who worked with CASA to take my kids. 2 children in foster care and 1 with his dad. I have only supervised visitation. CASA of Wyandotte and Johnson County has ruined my life."

"Would not recognize the child's disability or the hiring of a special Education law firm. Would not provide clarity of the case. Is associated with the city of USD232. Unconventional court appearances that were not recorded. Recused herself from the case and did not provide any explanation."

"She puts restrictions on me as a non party and didn't give me a chance to defend myself against the allegations that led to the restrictions and required no proof. She was moved off our cases and now we have new judges, waiting to see if anything changes"

"Did not care about any evidence I presented, gave everything to my ex and her POS lawyer and is making me pay her attorneys fees just for defending myself" **JOHNSON COUNTY**

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ks-catherine-decena-triplett/complaint-packet>

Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Jacquelyn Ellen Rokusek**JUDGE · JOHNSON COUNTY · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

"In our experience before Judge Rokusek in Johnson County, Kansas, the family court system appeared to favor one parent while allowing repeated violations, prolonged litigation, and unequal accountability, forcing our family into severe financial hardship, including foreclosure risk, additional jobs, and plasma donation to survive. The years of conflict, interference with therapy and activities, and instability imposed on our children damaged their well-being and relationships, while concerns regarding incomplete financial disclosures and misconduct went largely unaddressed." Judge Rokusek has allowed the ex wife's hidden assets and financial fraud and overwhelming litigation initiated by ex wife and multiple missed discovery deadlines to go without sanctions or consequences."

"Extreme conflict of interest with GAL she assigned to case. Has kept mother on strict supervised visitation for only 2 to 4 hrs per week for nearly 2 years. Issued temp order of sole custody to father for last school year but has refused to revisit the case, set status hearings or ease restricted visitation even though mother complied with court orders."

"Delayed and overlooked the entire case as a whole family. Ignored evidence, ignored the children. Made harsh judgments on allegations rather than facts."

"Never questioned the GAL recommendations or where he received any of his falsified information."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ks-jacquelyn-ellen-rokusek/complaint-packet>

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Niesha MiserTHERAPIST / COUNSELOR · JOHNSON COUNTY · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

"She believed mothers boohoo stories and did not believe the childrens accusations against mother, even though CINC court took children from mother. She advocated for their mother not the children." **JOHNSON**

"Actually told the court abuser was "healed" after only 3 visits. She's now locked in with a unethical court actor group that runs off Medicaid fraud"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ks-niesha-miser/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Phillip Journey

JUDGE · SEDGWICK · 4 SUBMISSIONS

"After a long tedious divorce process finalized in 2023, I asked for 50/50 custody and no child support. My ex was insidiously infiltrating our son's mind, and before I knew it, my son was completely against me. In 2024 my ex filed a motion for full custody using outlandish allegations and emergency custody with no evidence or due process — the judge signed the order that same day. It's been a year now since I've seen my son and I have yet to have one hearing."

"Ignored evidence that supported my case. Accepted evidence that was incomplete and only hear say as support to keep my children away from me. Delayed hearings; ignored motions; wasted time while my life and my kids' life was in his hands; left family court with no progress in my case for a year."

"Ignored evidence, refused to hear motion, laughed at child abuse stating something to the effect of "when I was young I was just glad the beating was over now kids get in their emotions these days""

"Laughs and Denies disabled litigants ADA (American with Disabilities Act) rights." SEDGWICK COUNTY

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ks-phillip-journey/complaint-packet>

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Sheri Wampler

CPS WORKER · COWLEY · 4 SUBMISSIONS

"She told me that if the biological mother disappeared that I would get my son back. I had been told my a friend to watch my back with her. I know that she talked with my girlfriend about disappearing for a while so that I could get my son back. She helped me get my son away from his grandmother and to a foster home. After I lost my son I found out that the foster parents were friends of hers and they wanted a baby boy."

"She tells the court that I have not been doing what she asks me to do to see my baby. 2 of the last four visits she has told me that I was there on the wrong day I have always had visit on the same day at the same time this month and it was saved in my phone. She tells me how happy my baby is with the foster parents. I met them and the Puchella's are strange." COWLEY

"Judge was a classmate and family friend of the case worker. Sheri Wampler from TFI was a "drinking buddy" with the bio father's attorney for one of the children. Wampler human-trafficked 3 siblings to her friend."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ks-sheri-wampler/complaint-packet>

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Steve Ellis

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · MIAMI COUNTY · 4 SUBMISSIONS

"Never met with children despite claiming to represent them in court. Believed the fathers statements against mother. Made decisions about her education without speaking to her teacher."

"Only listen to the father never the kids"

"Guardian ad litem"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ks-steve-ellis/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Steven D. Henry

ATTORNEY / GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · JOHNSON COUNTY · 4 SUBMISSIONS

"He downplayed very very serious emotional abuse evidence when HE filed a DCF report against my ex husband. Does not uphold violations of his own recommendations and takes no action when my ex husband violated court orders." JOHNSON

"Ignored evidence, ignored facts"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ks-steven-d-henry/complaint-packet>

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William F. Ebert III

OTHER · SHAWNEE COUNTY · 4 SUBMISSIONS

"Audited 200 cases by his bar number. Discovered a significant pattern of cases the children were being harmed. In the audits I also discovered he is sending his cases he has as a GAL/Case Manager/Conciliator to a specific therapist that lost their license in NE for sexual misconduct with patients. However in KS Mr. Ebert is subjecting people to use this therapist. Discovered overwhelming evidence he has been misleading the judges for years providing false information. Exploiting children to chaos for profit. Most of his case he was appointed to get much worse and prolonged for years once he got involved."

"Withheld evidence from court, manipulated school reporters, doctors, took away my rights each time kids reported abuse by other parent. Financially and emotionally exploitative, damaged my children and I and we still suffer due to his falsified evidence and unsafe recommendations."

"He had been actively representing opposing counsel since 2 months prior to being appointed as my domestic conciliator, at the recommendation of opposing counsel and has since switched primary residential custody and then terminated my parenting time without due process."

"Ignored evidence and facts, delayed unification Delayed reunification, false allegations were known and proven and still tried to convince judge otherwise."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ks-william-f-ebert-iii/complaint-packet>

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Allison Hibler

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · JACKSON/SHAWNEE · 4 SUBMISSIONS

"Lacks initiative to end delay tactics. Lacks effective explanatory communication. Truly believe she means well in my case, however is overly busy resulting in borderline neglect of active cases until necessary to respond just prior to approaching court dates. AKA Allison Maxwell Hibler, appears in log under both names needing merged." DOUGLAS

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ks-allison-hibler/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Ashlyn L. Yarnell**ATTORNEY / GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · JOHNSON · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

"Issued recommendations with no substantiated evidence. Refuses to hear any narrative other by than my ex husband. Stated in open court that she will not consider a change in parenting time until she is laid in full It has taken my life. Father alleging parental alienation versus actual emotional abuse and neglect of children by him."

"Ashlyn fabricated evidence and hod evidence that the minor child was illegally living out of state with a convicted felon. She covered up the illegal move, drug use, and convicted felon status"

"She was briefly my ex husbands attorney."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ks-ashlyn-l-yarnell/complaint-packet>

Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Brenda CoppTHERAPIST / COUNSELOR · JOHNSON · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

"This woman is dangerous and needs her license STRIPPED FROM HER!!! False reports, fraud, unethical, unprofessional, biased and caused more damage for my child than not. Absolutely evil"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ks-brenda-copp/complaint-packet>

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Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

KANSAS AT A GLANCE.

Across 272 Kansas families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 496 270 of 272 families reported child counts	MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN \$97,450 median across 140 families reporting 3+ categories	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 16 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 48.5% 132 of 272 who answered; 109 of 272 ran out of money
SUBMISSIONS 272	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.8	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 270 of 272	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 65

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Kansas families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

03 THE COST OF KANSAS FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	174	\$25,000	\$49,405	\$8,596,452
Lost Wages	133	\$10,000	\$38,141	\$5,072,762
Other Court Fees	83	\$2,000	\$5,319	\$441,491
Therapy / Evaluations	127	\$3,000	\$5,128	\$651,258
Reunification Services	85	\$500	\$3,702	\$314,699
GAL Fees	120	\$3,250	\$8,338	\$1,000,530
Asset Loss ¹	100	\$38,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (140 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	\$97,450	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least \$1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$38,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS



04 WHO IS REPORTING · KANSAS

Most families documenting in Kansas are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		132	49%
Case closed: within last 2 years		44	16%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		31	11%
Not provided		26	10%
Not in court but still affected		22	8%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Family Court Only		135	50%
Both Family Court and CPS		103	38%
CPS Only		18	7%
Unknown		16	6%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		80	30%
5 – 10 years		57	22%
3 – 5 years		50	19%
Over 10 years		35	13%
6 months – 1 year		24	9%

CUSTODY STATUS

50/50 Joint		84	31%
No Contact / Total Loss of Access		68	25%
Visitation Only		49	18%
Full Custody		31	11%
Adopted Out (Rights Terminated)		20	7%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Johnson		75	33%
Shawnee		21	9%
Sedgwick		15	7%
Miami		15	7%
Cowley		6	3%
Lyon		6	3%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		69	25%
High Conflict Divorce		55	20%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		51	19%
Other		25	9%
Other: (Short answer)		16	6%

05 PARENT VOICES — KANSAS

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Kansas comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



The Kansas court system is so corrupt. It's not even funny and judge Mativi is my judge. She awarded custody to someone who had no witnesses when I had five witnesses saying he smoked marijuana with my kids in the room and abused me and the children.

— CIERRA

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

It didn't just take my 5 kids—it took birthdays, holidays, and the everyday moments that make a family. We've been forced to live in a nightmare of silence, separation, and trauma that never should have happened. This system protected court insiders and unchecked power instead of [...]

— KANSAS PARENT · MEGHANN

MORE VOICES FROM KANSAS

System was complicit in alienating my children from me. Attorneys, GAL's, a Case Manager, Therapists, Judges, KVC. I have spent well over \$150,000 over a two year period of time only to have two of my 3 children go no contact. No abuse, no drugs or addiction problems. All of [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They almost broke me, they took my kids, forced me to leave my husband alienated us individually. And then when I kept fighting they used threats and coercion to force me out of my kids lives. I fought against corruption, abuse of power and trafficking, and lost. I survived but [...]

— DESIREE

My kids are traumatized from being ripped away from who was their primary caregiver their entire lives for zero valid reason, and I am forever changed because of the abuse I've endured through this process.

— TAYLOR

Systematically destroyed and traumatized my daughter. Set her up to go into an abusive relationship. My daughter wrote the judge a personal letter, called dcf, and reported her fathers abuse to the police twice. She was totally ignored and forced to remain with her psychopathic [...]

— SATAH

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



It's legalized extortion- judicial mafia- attorneys and judges are all in on it. Casa, CPS and local pd - no one really cares- inept and unprofessional

— KELLY

Corrupt judges, attorneys and other court appointed professionals abused their position to extort money from my family by issuing orders and directives for the sole purpose of causing harm to my children. These officers of the Court are intentionally committing crimes for the [...]

— MIKE

Destroyed. Children still in foster care. Kinship ignored. Creating trauma for CHILDREN, emotional regulation, safety, grossly over medicating, stability, separation, splitting full siblings apart without visitation. Good case workers who put the children first would vanish [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ex parte orders issued taking away parenting time/no contact. I had sole custody, also taken away with the appointment of a new GAL on the case for a few months. No evidence presented, no witnesses and Judge delays setting evidentiary hearing. I have always been the primary [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

THE SYSTEM IS CORRUPT AND YOU HAVE TO PAY TO PLAY! GOOD PARENTS ARE LOSING THEIR CHILDREN OVER \$\$\$\$\$!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has caused unneeded separation from my autistic son and his service dog! The system has stripped me of my medical rights and the funds needed for the betterment of my children have been spent instead on the system.

— AMY

The system has allowed my abuser to continue to have access to me and my financials years after escaping and being no contact. The judge has ordered more financial harm regardless of proof. She's even ordered me to do things that significantly negatively impact my children that [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



My kids and I have separation anxiety we have to do a lot of Mental Health more than we ever had in our life bad things has happened to my oldest daughter while in custody my family will never be the same we will never get that time back that they messed up on we have lost out [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It is called KIDNAPPING children from the parents and grandparents without visitation rights has caused Me and My Family POST TRAUMATIC STRESS UNCUREABLE

— ANGELA

It's just corrupt. Don't want to say more than that. But that judge is no good.

— HANNA

The system is failing my daughter by dismissing abuse claims because the opposing attorney knows our GAL and it seems our GAL is unable to remain unbiased. My case is one sided and leaning always toward dad. What's best for the children is no longer what the system is going off [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My exhusband had criminal charges for taking the life of our unborn child through DV and would not allow my daughter to get me medical help. He was charged for 1 misdemeanor (domestic battery) and 1 felony charge (intimidation of a minor) in 2022. GAL Heather Landon was on the [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Traumatized my child in foster care due to abuse. Caused unnecessary mental distress to me as the mother resulting in loss of job affiliated with prosecutor communication with my employment. Took my right and my child's right to be with her mother. Opened my eyes to government [...]

— CARLY

My kids are still traumatized very acting home for 3 years now and there was not in foster care they were with my brother they did go out for about a month to have a false apparent but still are very traumatized

— JESSIE

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



The courts took sides with our abuser by refusing to let us leave the county, discounting all of the sacrifice and effort that i have put into giving my children the safest, happiest environment they could be in and completely upended their lives by imposing a 2-2-3 schedule on [...]

— SHEENA

My life has been destroyed by family courts stealing my child with false allegations. I no longer own a home or have a place to live.

— ROBERT

My children's childhood was stolen from them. They were taken on false allegations over 3 years. Which were all determined unsubstantiated- they still have not returned home. They have been withheld court ordered therapy treatment for 3 years with no enforcement that could help [...]

— MEL

My custody time was decreased due to lack of investigative efforts by CPS and GAL, resulting in progressive and ongoing psychological and physical harm being inflicted upon my children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Further traumatized my daughter and demonized mother despite mother consistently doing what I was told to do and providing for the children's needs.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The Miami county Kansas family court system has destroyed so much in my life over two years of lost time with my daughter destroyed my reputation around our area with false allegations and continue to do so

— GIB

The system ultimately failed my kids. My kids had to deal with years of harassment, lies, manipulation from their father, and the court still hasn't held him accountable for it. Now myself and children are in therapy, I still have to make my 2 youngest go 50-50 with him. He lost [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



An alienating parent was given the reign to further false stories, and further the harm to children. The loving, alienated parent was traumatized and harmed continuously to keep momentum and fodder. Devastation.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My kids are being mentally destroyed and ruined due to false accusations, inappropriate sexual behavior, and no guidance or protection. The system is pushing and taking our children's voices away by forcing them to lie and speak to protect one person and teaching them to put [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have not seen my children in over 16 months. I was ordered to do counseling, of which my children seldomly attended. My children are suffering in school, failing classes, suspensions, and etc and GAL hasn't spoken to anyone of importance or done his job. Children's mother [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has retraumatized me repeatedly, increased my disability symptoms from the extra stress and trauma to the point that I can't work, caused my children to be traumatized from the acts and behaviors of the other party. It has left me bankrupt, put me back in an unsafe [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My children were denied their due process rights.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It demolished my nervous system, made repeating myself a PTSD trigger, created a phobia of police, my son was institutionalized because the DA ignored the schools concerns just to traumatize me, it put us in survival mode. I can't be my children's payee because I was punished for [...]

— JULIANN

The system took my kids a whole year without due process. It cost me everything that I value. I'm sharing this because I want people to know that this is immoral, illegal, and unconstitutional. These people need to be held accountable for all their actions. Meg I need your help [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

174 Kansas parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 34 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — KANSAS

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Kansas families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

The Kansas court system is so corrupt. It's not even funny and judge Mativi is my judge . She awarded custody to someone who had no witnesses when I had five witnesses saying he smoked marijuana with my kids in the room and abused me and the children.

— CIERRA

It didn't just take my 5 kids—it took birthdays, holidays, and the everyday moments that make a family. We've been forced to live in a nightmare of silence, separation, and trauma that never should have happened. This system protected court insiders and unchecked power instead of protecting children and due process. It stripped my parental rights without proof, then kept the separation going through delays, restrictions, and retaliation.

— MEGHANN

System was complicit in alienating my children from me. Attorneys, GAL's, a Case Manager, Therapists, Judges, KVC. I have spent well over \$150,000 over a two year period of time only to have two of my 3 children go no contact. No abuse, no drugs or addiction problems. All of this over screens and permissive parenting.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They almost broke me, they took my kids, forced me to leave my husband alienated us individually. And then when I kept fighting they used threats and coercion to force me out of my kids lives. I fought against corruption, abuse of power and trafficking, and lost. I survived but I only made it out with my youngest son because I saw what they would try to do and was a step ahead, now we're forever running. They can't quiet me, should my children come looking for me later in life I want to ensure they find that I never gave up, never stopped fighting for them.

— DESIREE

My kids are traumatized from being ripped away from who was their primary caregiver their entire lives for zero valid reason, and I am forever changed because of the abuse I've endured through this process.

— TAYLOR

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Systematically destroyed and traumatized my daughter. Set her up to go into an abusive relationship. My daughter wrote the judge a personal letter, called dcf, and reported her fathers abuse to the police twice. She was totally ignored and forced to remain with her psychopathic abusive father.

— SATAH

It's legalized extortion- judicial mafia- attorneys and judges are all in on it. Casa, CPS and local pd - no one really cares- inept and unprofessional

— KELLY

Corrupt judges, attorneys and other court appointed professionals abused their position to extort money from my family by issuing orders and directives for the sole purpose of causing harm to my children. These officers of the Court are intentionally committing crimes for the sole purpose of stealing money from broken families and these crimes are routinely and consistently committed by the same individuals. The Johnson County Kansas family court system is a cesspool full of narcissistic and incestuous behavior by these so-called officers of the Court.

— MIKE

Destroyed. Children still in foster care. Kinship ignored. Creating trauma for CHILDREN, emotional regulation, safety, grossly over medicating, stability, separation, splitting full siblings apart without visitation. Good case workers who put the children first would vanish after a month or two. All for federal block grants and funding. The children's best interest was not considered. 3 judges and five lawyers in 5 years, numerous case workers. I'm fighting to make it until my babies reach 18. Systemic abuse has been deep and total.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ex parte orders issued taking away parenting time/no contact. I had sole custody, also taken away with the appointment of a new GAL on the case for a few months. No evidence presented, no witnesses and Judge delays setting evidentiary hearing. I have always been the primary caregiver. Ex husband had been found guilty during a custody trial of emotional and verbal abuse. The system has failed me and my kids. GALs and case managers have too much power.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

THE SYSTEM IS CORRUPT AND YOU HAVE TO PAY TO PLAY! GOOD PARENTS ARE LOSING THEIR CHILDREN OVER \$\$\$\$\$!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has caused unneeded separation from my autistic son and his service dog! The system has stripped me of my medical rights and the funds needed for the betterment of my children have been spent instead on the system.

— AMY

The system has allowed my abuser to continue to have access to me and my financials years after escaping and being no contact. The judge has ordered more financial harm regardless of proof. She's even ordered me to do things that significantly negatively impact my children that I'm the primary care giver for with no support system. One child with special needs. She doesn't care. He's lied and contradicted himself many times demanding harm to me which should be a red flag for coercive control and a need for power and control. To hear that what's being demanded would be harmful to my children and he pushed for it knowing it doesn't affect him shows incredible desire to cause more harm. Significant lack of empathy. Even an attorney recognized this person isn't seeking resolution, he seeking to cause harm. It's obvious but the judge refuses to see it and has become his tool since he lost access to me any other way.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My kids and I have separation anxiety we have to do a lot of Mental Health more than we ever had in our life bad things has happened to my oldest daughter while in custody my family will never be the same we will never get that time back that they messed up on we have lost out on times as a family my children were abused while in foster care DCF knew about it kvc knew about it and they tried to cover it up which they did I was told my kids are better off without me I got silenced because I always showed up with proof yet still got denied to bring it up at times or it was irrelevant they said I was told let my kids have a voice because I always speak for my children and I because a lot of times they were scared to speak up in front of them at court so I did that for them attorneys g a l prosecutors nobody cares because it wasn't them and their family going through this

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It is called KIDNAPPING children from the parents and grandparents without visitation rights has caused Me and My Family POST TRAUMATIC STRESS UNCUREABLE

— ANGELA

It's just corrupt. Don't want to say more than that. But that judge is no good.

— HANNA

The system is failing my daughter by dismissing abuse claims because the opposing attorney knows our GAL and it seems our GAL is unable to remain unbiased. My case is one sided and leaning always toward dad. What's best for the children is no longer what the system is going off of.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My exhusband had criminal charges for taking the life of our unborn child through DV and would not allow my daughter to get me medical help. He was charged for 1 misdemeanor (domestic battery) and 1 felony charge (intimidation of a minor) in 2022. GAL Heather Landon was on the case at the time and continued to force the children into reintegration therapy even though the DA said it would taint the case. I had sole custody of all three children from 2021 to 2024. The children started talking with Father, made claims against me now, which caused a CINC case against me. Father's charges were dropped due to him gaining contact with the older children through GAL John Domoney and TFI agents. My youngest daughter was with me still until October of 2025, I could no longer afford to take her to reintegration with Naomi Catadeulla 2 1:2 hrs away from my home once a week and 4 other appointments with sandy Boltons case managers and therapist Janderon Lyold. The GAL believes all allegations against me. Won't allow me any contact with the kids. I don't even know where they are living, go to school nothing and on paper, I still have sole custody. Andy will not allow me to chose my own reintegration therapist, I have to go to the one father demands, his buddy Naomi Catadella. My youngest daughter is 10, she can't sleep without me. The therapist are lying that she is scared of me. I lost my kids to the REAL abuser and Andy Bolton and Richard Fisher painted me as crazy, took my voice. Please let there be someone that can help me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Traumatized my child in foster care due to abuse. Caused unnecessary mental distress to me as the mother resulting in loss of job affiliated with prosecutor communication with my employment. Took my right and my child's right to be with her mother. Opened my eyes to government control and violation of BASIC rights.

— CARLY

My kids are still traumatized very acting home for 3 years now and there was not in foster care they were with my brother they did go out for about a month to have a false apparent but still are very traumatized

— JESSIE

The courts took sides with our abuser by refusing to let us leave the county, discounting all of the sacrifice and effort that i have put into giving my children the safest, happiest environment they could be in and completely upended their lives by imposing a 2-2-3 schedule on children who had been with their mother in residential custody their whole lives. My kids went from happy, well-adjusted, and thriving to emotional, suicidal, and angry in the blink of an eye. Essentially, the courts have destroyed their childhood and their mental health completely.

— SHEENA

My life has been destroyed by family courts stealing my child with false allegations. I no longer own a home or have a place to live.

— ROBERT

My children's childhood was stolen from them. They were taken on false allegations over 3 years. Which were all determined unsubstantiated- they still have not returned home. They have been withheld court ordered therapy treatment for 3 years with no enforcement that could help them heal

— MEL

My custody time was decreased due to lack of investigative efforts by CPS and GAL, resulting in progressive and ongoing psychological and physical harm being inflicted upon my children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Further traumatized my daughter and demonized mother despite mother consistently doing what I was told to do and providing for the children's needs.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The Miami county Kansas family court system has destroyed so much in my life over two years of lost time with my daughter destroyed my reputation around our area with false allegations and continue to do so

— GIB

The system ultimately failed my kids. My kids had to deal with years of harassment, lies, manipulation from their father, and the court still hasn't held him accountable for it. Now myself and children are in therapy, I still have to make my 2 youngest go 50-50 with him. He lost custody of our oldest 1.5 years ago due to GAL recommendations. I've been put into financial hardships from paying for attorneys, therapists, and other fees only for him to get away with the horrible things he's done. They don't care about families. They care about lining their pockets.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

An alienating parent was given the reign to further false stories, and further the harm to children. The loving, alienated parent was traumatized and harmed continuously to keep momentum and fodder. Devastation.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My kids are being mentally destroyed and ruined due to false accusations, inappropriate sexual behavior, and no guidance or protection. The system is pushing and taking our children's voices away by forcing them to lie and speak to protect one person and teaching them to put that person first even when it hurts them.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I have not seen my children in over 16 months. I was ordered to do counseling, of which my children seldomly attended. My children are suffering in school, failing classes, suspensions, and etc and GAL hasn't spoken to anyone of importance or done his job. Children's mother falsely accused me of abuse and has bought my children's love all while telling them lies about me. After years of fighting to do what is best for my children.....I have finally given up. Once you understand how the system works, only a fool would believe they could win going against it.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has retraumatized me repeatedly, increased my disability symptoms from the extra stress and trauma to the point that I can't work, caused my children to be traumatized from the acts and behaviors of the other party. It has left me bankrupt, put me back in an unsafe situation, with my children experiencing threats of harm from the other party. DV doesn't stop when you leave, the abuser weaponizes the legal system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My children were denied their due process rights.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It demolished my nervous system, made repeating myself a PTSD trigger, created a phobia of police, my son was institutionalized because the DA ignored the schools concerns just to traumatize me, it put us in survival mode. I can't be my childrens payee because I was punished for not playing along and they didn't report his placement right away and I was trying to keep a roof for him to come home to. Always hoops, hassle and punishment for existing all these years later. I'm so tired of being punished for having lived a nightmare, my reputation was destroyed in my hometown so I'm scared to go visit my family, and people treat me like a villain because of my accusers lies while she's assumed to be a hero.

— JULIANN

The system took my kids a whole year without due process. It cost me everything that I value. I'm sharing this because I want people to know that this is immoral, illegal, and unconstitutional. These people need to be held accountable for all their actions. Meg I need your help please.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My life revolves around soul crushing court ordered abuse. My child has been legally kidnapped to our abuser.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

In the process of going through this I became very very depressed I don't trust anyone I never sleep I used to own a company that I wanted to have as a family business and I was doing great now I can barely focus on even stepping out the back door or the front door of my house I've lost my so-called license to drive been in jail many times been beat up in jail by the COS my phone's been hacked by the county of Osage or the state of Kansas I found out through guardio it's difficult for me to focus to work I've gone broke my house is falling apart Nothing in life is the way it should be I don't even get to call my kids for one minute each once per year to say I love you I get nothing they changed my kids' names and my girls they even change their first names I've been put in jail for trying to contact the cop lady who adopted my kids via messenger she told me to stop so I stopped however she still pressed charges on me and the judge still put me in jail been a while after that they put false drug charges on me I did almost a year by the miracle of God I was let out after 7 months just before Thanksgiving the whole time in the beginning the first couple years I was so stressed out and so depressed my health failed I was dying from it I had a small stroke and I started having thyroid issues my skin was falling off me my legs are so swollen they felt like they're going to burst I know I was within inches of death broken heart disease yeah that's a real one too I experienced it I still am

— JOE

I was part of a government sting where I lured in to a hotel recommended by an ex to where I was unknowingly monitored and surveillanced followed by gang stalking and multiple attempts of trying to set me up. This system has mentally, emotionally, and spiritually damaged my children and I due to false accusations. They separated my son from his brother and sister after termination of my rights during Covid. And after being coerced by a local non profit organization that they were on my side and would be my support while still involved with the system after having my twins, I gave them temporary guardian while I continued treatment and therapy and obtaining employment. After 7 months everything the testified under oath in court to helping me succeed they did complete opposite and had people come into my life to make me fail and moved to termination.

— BRITTANY

It had destroyed my children's mental health and mine. My youngest has become suicidal, which is everyday.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This devastating case has caused immense emotional and irreparable damage to our Grandchildren and our entire family.

— JODEE

The system created an environment that allowed my children to think their mother abused them and did want them. I have one child that calls me by my first name. The court said my ex could do whatever he wanted. And he did. They helped him in every way they could

— TRACEY

Lost custody due to not having representation at all,, and the judge not bothering to investigate the false claims. I never even got a chance to speak or give evidence.

— TRISH

The system recognizes the abuser then gives your children to them. The system is used to continue to control and abuse Domestic Violence Survivors, and to retraumatize them repeatedly.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My Grandmother (whom i was living with) died of a heartattack the day they came and took my daughter, while she was lying there dying she kept saying "dont let the paramedics see you here taking care of your daughter" (they gave me one hour to move out of my house that day. My Son was given back to his abusinve father at the same time and had to grow up without his sister, hes since been given back to me but i was forced to sign my rights away attter i was lied to and offered no help as the pandemic took all resources away for awhile, I may had dabbled with drugs a little but i was not a junkie, i was not using a needle or heroin, i had a full time job and took care of my kids better than anyone else in this world could, they needed for nothing, she never even had a diaper rash while with me, we had a nice house, there was NO reason they should have deemed me unfit because i failed their drug tests the tricked me with and then took my precious baby, at 3 months old, how could any human being sit in that cold chair and watch a mothers heart break lilterally in two for a stone cold paycheck, a woman who by-the-way was morbidly obese (a lifestyle choice she makes) to the point i dont see her taking care of herself let alone the child she was about to have, how could she give that child the care it takes to keep up with all a bably and then toddler require if she cant even do it for herself, bc of a life decision she was making, the same as we all do when we decide to do whatever it is that we shouldnt be doing, it DOESNT always make us unfit parents, granted i can see the stigma as alot of people give drugs a bad name lol im not justifying them but ok i know im guilty of the

— TIFFANY (1/2)

run on sentence so i wont even finish that thought but you can prob. guess the excuse i was getting ready to give there lol thanks for listening

— TIFFANY (2/2)

All I do is cry. Not because I am hurting. Because of the unimaginable pain my children are in with out me. They barely had a childhood between their father killing his self in front of us (me and the twins at 3 years old) and being ripped away from mommy at 7 and a half years.

— TINA

The system has destroyed our lives

— MATTHEW

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Failed to protect me and my children who are victims of a crime, Level 7 and level 10 felony, Expects money in return for justice.

— COREY

Caused my children trauma and placed them with my abusive ex husband.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ripped up apart. Made us broke & homeless. Every time I try they knock me down. They never say a good thing about me or anything I do or have done. The judge said she wasn't comfortable letting me keep my kids. There was lies made up about me & i love my kids very much and im just heartbroken..

— JASMYN

I was put through EXTREME STRESS, and was always warned what I could or couldn't say to the kids. I did suffer health issues!!!!

— MONICA

Gaslighted and emotionally abused my family.

— KIMBERLEE

Stole my kids and never helped me get the resources or support they are promising families to reintegrate.

— LISA

Cause depression, loss of time and mental abuse on siblings and family members

— ANNETTA

Deprived my son and I of our God given rights as a father and son

— JOHN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

After dealing with Lewanna Bell-Lloyd, and CPS, it proved to me there's no "justice" in the justice system.

— PAUL

Taken a good quality mother away from her children due to the father not wanting to pay child support. Father has made multiple false allegations, called cps, and stalked and harassed me from day one.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Never, in the history of humanity, have children had their medical, educational, adjudicative, due process and administrative needs met by a series of portals and videoconferences set up entirely in response to a pandemic that has long passed. Children are being sold back to their own parents, most of whom have no failed drug tests, no findings of incompetence, and no criminal histories, by a series of tele-lawyers, tele-judges, tele-doctors, tele-social workers and tele-GALS who are using their licenses, wealth and influence to run what is essentially a lucrative human trafficking racket under the guise of law.

— SHAWN

Ripped us apart and stole my children's chances at a happy healthy childhood and adulthood.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Alienated me from my children. Completely.

— CASEY

Family court is pay to win. People need to know that fair/equality do not exist, only who can afford an attorney longer.

— CHRISTOPHER

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

For four years, I fought through a family court system that completely failed my children and me. In a small town where my ex-husband was a well-known doctor, it felt like every professional involved already believed his version of events before I was ever heard. I was forced through humiliating supervised visitation for nearly a year, subjected to guardian ad litem investigations and a Child in Need of Care case that never should have escalated the way it did, while my children were emotionally traumatized in the process. The people who were supposed to protect families instead empowered manipulation, intimidation, and abuse. I lost irreplaceable years with my children because of a system that gave one person power, influence, and credibility while treating me like I had to constantly prove I deserved to be their mother. In order to finally bring my children home, I was pressured into signing paperwork giving up 41 months of child support — something I later learned should never have been used as leverage against custody or parenting time in the first place. Even after court-ordered support was established, he still paid only what he wanted while contributing nothing toward helping our children build their futures. The emotional damage to my children, the financial devastation, and the years we can never get back are the true cost of what this system allowed to happen.

— TAMIE

They kidnapped my son based on false allegations, and killed the sibling bond between my boys!!!

— SANDEE

Family Court does not have fiduciary representation for the members of high-cost attorneys. The Attorneys collaborate with Judges and Social Workers for their firms best interest. Not the actual client.

— ANDREW

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I fought for my children with everything I had in me. I followed every rule, met every demand, jumped through every hoop they placed in front of me, but all they did was move the finish line. The system was never built on fairness, it is built on power. And when you stand against it, they will do anything to bury it. They are untouchable, hiding behind procedures while breaking the very family it claims to protect. It took my voice piece by piece, until I no longer recognized myself. It drained my strength, my hope, my will to keep going. Losing a child to the system like this isn't just loss, it's erasure. It's being told that your love, your effort, your truth... wasn't enough. But I know what I did. I know how hard I fought. And even if the system refused to see it, that fight was real. That love IS real. And no system, no matter how corrupt or powerful, can take that truth away from me. I will never stop fighting.

— ALI

Taken away time together we can never get back. Make my children and I feel we had no control or voice

— SHAE

Turned my children against me we don't talk they have no respect for me I don't get to see grandbaby's nothing

— JENNIFER

Devastated..given me a drive to shut it down. The kids are a close friend of mine.

— KEVIN

This system has not protect my children. My ex is a doctor and has used his influence and money to keep my children in an abusive situation. He along with his crony lawyer and judge are single handedly ruining my children's lives.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Completely evaporated my life and relationship with absolutely everybody. They have made me alone and restless and timid.

— TAYLOR

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Children's safety was ignored. We feel the court system is racially biased.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has destroyed the mental and emotional health of me and my children and are nervous systems. We will be forever changed by this experience. we pray every day that we're together again, and that justice is truly served.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Allowed the gal and judge too much power to make a decision to separate a mother from her children with no evidence or ability to defend her self due to the unethical court process. Judge allowed a conflict of interest and did not allow any evidence to be provided. Respondent was tokd he filed first and this was the reason I was given every other weekend. This is not an ethical reason to separate a mother from her children. This case was about who had the money, not what was best for the children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Time with my daughter as well as putting my daughter at risk. Her dad has threatened to leave with her and go off grid if I ever reported the abuse.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Miami county doesn't have the child best interest at all, they literally take children away from a parent who wants to protect them from abuse and drugs and tells the parent that wants to keep them safe that they are a vindictive ex who is mad!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I lost my son, my job, and my girlfriend because of TFI, Sheri Wampler and Judge St. Peter.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Judge St. Peter has cost me my child.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Torn us apart. Reintroduced my violent ex after he said she wasn't his and 2 years of no contact.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Naomi Cataudella's involvement did not heal our family's trauma — it prolonged and deepened it. Instead of helping rebuild trust and emotional safety, Naomi's approach empowered an abuser, left our children feeling unheard, intensified family division, and reinforced a system where fear and dysfunction were repeatedly overlooked.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Wore out. Detrimental to children's mental, emotional, psychological health by ignoring what's best for the children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ripped two children from the only home they had ever known and from their mother and the maternal family who raised them. Haven't been able to see children outside of strictly supervised visitation, for no more than 2 to 4 hours per week in nearly 2 full years.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have ripped apart my family, my heart is still broken it has been years they were taken as we were passing through Kansas from Kentucky. My family is in Kentucky we are all separated

— MELISSA

It has destroyed my family. My daughter is in an abusive environment begging to come home.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Robbed memories, broken my family apart, and turned my kids against me

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system and those in it s have systematically and meticulously destroyed the relationship I had with my son and the relationship between siblings based upon nothing more than their personal biases

— ALETHEA

I have lost my children, filed bankruptcy, and lost my career due to ongoing litigation rooted in coercive control and manipulation.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has cut me out of my daughter's life and have manipulated her and turned her against me and have handed her over to her pedophile father who never wanted anything to do with her and only wants her now for her disability check and he has already committed tax fraud by claiming her on his taxes! St Francis needs shut down and the whole system needs to be changed and new people hired! I have lost everything! My daughter was my whole world and I was just trying to get her the help for her mental illness that she so desperately needs!

— APRIL

The have kidnapped my visitation and my ex has done the same

— JOHN

Missing out out on my kids whole youth years. Ill never get the time back.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I was the primary caretaker for my children prior to divorce, post divorce we had 50/50 custody and time. She stalked me, controlled schedules, and manipulated the situation because she is the "mother" and she wanted control so took me back to court over things that could have been a discussion. She committed perjury, manipulated stories on the stand and her and her witnesses made me out to be a terrible father. Now I only get to see my kids every other weekend and pay a crazy amount of child support that I can't afford. My attorney didn't stand up for me at all, and proved she lied on the stand. I followed all court documents and mediated agreements but was turned around on me in court.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Traumatized my son to the point he begs for me & says he doesn't like Daddy.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have taken my child and everything i owned. Im living witjout power and water

— DUSTIN

What was suppose to be a short weekend visit turned into months of separation from my daughter,even though there were no finding of abuse or neglect. The time and memories lost between parent and child are something that no system or courts can ever truly give back. I am sharing my experience in hopes that situations like this recieve more transparency and accountability so other families do not lose time with their children the way I did.

— LINDSEY

The system allowed my abuser to escape all consequences to the point of his criminal charges being dismissed and helped Dad turning me into the abuser. The system has stripped me of any belief that leaving my abuser was the right choice. I wish I would have stayed, at least I wpuld still have my children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The court system has taken Away my son's mother my other kids brother Kevin o Grady needs to be exposed he claims he does things for the kids safety no he breaks families

— EMILY

Have my child to their abuser.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has ripped apart my family and caused a divide. It caused half of my family to want nothing to do with me due to their lies.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It taken away most of my past 20 years and will always.

— ANNIE

Destroyed a family because of someone's feelings with no evidence to substantiate claims

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

they altered photos, lied on the stand, ignored facts, and told me to be quiet when I tried to prove their lies. my son was failing all classes, not taking meds, quit wrestling and was eventually sent with paternal family states away but "in my custody still" with no rights whatsoever

— HILLARY

It has severely effected my son getting the proper care he needs which has cost him everything in his development

— CURTIS

This the single biggest trauma of my life. Guardian Ad Litem are the biggest threat to the family court system and their power must be checked.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Kept me from seeing my children and all me to parent them

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I havent seen my kids in 3+ years. The court enabled alienation and swept a court ordered report under rug which showed signs of alienation.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Complete and total devastation and torment.

— MEGAN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It has caused permanent damage to my children. Our bond is severely affected.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has internally killed me and stolen motherhood from me. I have 2 other children that are also heavily impacted both financially and emotionally.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This case transferred after 10 years and once the new county took over it has systematically broken the bond to irreparable damage. The children's childhood was stolen being forced to court hearings and being subjected to lawyers.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I'm a survivor of domestic violence. My 2 abusive exes constantly made false allegations against me. CASA ignored the mountains of evidence that I had. I lost my kids due to false allegations and CASA. DCF knew all the reports were false and had no concerns with me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Caused my kids and ptsd that they still suffer from, depression, they are absolutely terrified of the cops and dcf anytime any of these people are around my kids have behaviors and become vital sick.

— SUSAN

For over a decade the system has used my struggle as a now single mother of 6, living in poverty, receiving no child support....into a sort of financial status discrimination act. Making me appear to be unfit to parent my own children and all because im poor. Making it appear as though I am guilty of emotionally neglecting my kids. My kids are my proof in the pudding....healthy, thriving, happy, loving, strong persevering, smart, school aged children. Proving money doesn't make you an automatic good parent! I stand with Meg! Shantel

— SHANTEL

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Family Court has done nothing but destroy my once happy little family by handing total control over to our abusers.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The Leavenworth County family court and the mishandling of the Covid epidemic in Kansas allowed my ex spouse to alienate my children from me. I have not spoken to three of my children in over six years now.

— TONY

Two years without your children is a lot of time. Missing teeth and first days. It's not just hard on us. They're home now, But we're all so, so very mentally and emotionally fucked, each in our own ways, and I'm scared we won't ever be the same.

— ASHLEE

The system has deprive me of the opportunity to raise, love, and shape my daughter. The system has lied, destroyed, and robbed me of not only my daughter, but my entire relationship with my family.

— HANNAH

My daughter being in the KVC foster care system cause further trauma for her and for our family. It place her in direct danger, lack of counseling, medical neglect, financial burden, and stress.

— HEATHER

Ruined my entire life. And my innocent child's life.

— ALYSSA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Over the course of years, this system has forced me to expend extraordinary financial, emotional, and physical resources to protect my children from ongoing harm, while repeatedly allowing noncompliance, delay, and manipulation to continue unchecked. The result has been severe economic loss, instability, and trauma for both me and my children, despite my consistent efforts to follow court orders and secure their safety and care.

— NICOLE

When systems meant to protect children fail to conduct a full and fair investigation and rely on biased recommendations, the result is devastating. My children are struggling emotionally, and I live with the daily pain of being separated from them despite having been their primary caregiver.

— JESSICA

This system had denied me and my children of not only the present, but also the future. The psychological damaged can not be undone and will effect the future generations of me and my children.

— RACQUEL

Destroyed my son mentally and emotionally, rubbed him of a childhood. I'm on 4 different anxiety meds, heart failure, autistic immune disease, debilitating depression. I trust no one, don't sleep, we both live in constant fear and anxiety

— KELLY

The system has determined that I am only worth a paycheck, to my ex, as a mother.

— TONYA

Judge Keven O'Grady forced me to pay for supervised visits for a mother that attempted suicide in front of a 5 year old. "As many visits as she wants" at \$100/hour.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Johnson county courts are a closn court that caters to the dysfunctional pedophile parents.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I was falsely accused of physical abuse on my child and lost my visitation for over 2 months, this has created a fear in my child that she's going to go for her scheduled parenting time with her father and never get to see me again. My child has to be with her alleged abuser 50% of the time that breaks my heart, but what can I do to fix it?

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Kansas family courts are an absolute scam. I went into this in 2012 believing in the system. I quickly learned it's all political and money driven and NOT about the children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Turn me into a weekend(vacation) parent, removed them from their home to give her bf residential custody because she can't afford to live independently. Exposing my daughters to perpetual narcissistic behavior.

— WILLIAM

"In our experience before Judge Rokusek in Johnson County, Kansas, the family court system appeared to favor one parent while allowing repeated violations, prolonged litigation, and unequal accountability, forcing our family into severe financial hardship, including foreclosure risk, additional jobs, and plasma donation to survive. The years of conflict, interference with therapy and activities, and instability imposed on our children damaged their well-being and relationships, while concerns regarding incomplete financial disclosures and misconduct went largely unaddressed. 45 months later, fighting a new teal appeal after our first was appealed."

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My ex-husband and I filed pro se to divorce and I just remember judge Montgomery telling us that our daughter did not ask to be brought into this world and we better behave accordingly to not be back in front of him and to do right by her.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Taken away the most valuable time from their youth. They treated my child like a commodity and not a human life.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My life is in ruins. I have started shooting up and selling my body for McDonald's rewards points.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Had I known what the family court system would put us through, I may have stayed in an abusive marriage until my children were grown. Leaving should have protected us; instead, the system prolonged the harm and made survival feel like punishment.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Cannot trust any court system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Alienating, grief & loss, constitutional violators, unjustified kidnapping. They made my son vulnerably of statics of young men without fathers when he has one. Kids shouldn't have to wait to turn 18 to have a relationship with a parent.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

it has completely turned our lives upside down.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system allowed a nonparent to weaponize the courts against my family, costing us our stability, our savings, and years of peace.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It's erased my identity as a mother, and denied my children a safe home. It's all but taken away my ability to teach my children necessary life lessons and abandoned them to quiet neglect in their home.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has been devastating to watch my granddaughter suffer the consequences of a judge making decisions based on a desire to flex her power, rather than that of constitutional law, appellate court rulings, and mostly what was in the best interest and safety of a child, for over 15 years.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has helped to tear apart a children from their mother, the only parent to take care of all their needs since birth. Gave my abusive ex control over me even after divorce causing tremendous mental anguish.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It is a predatory system that preys on families with financial means to be engaged in the system for years on end. It is the kids that suffer the most.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The courts, criminal and civil, and police have neglected to protect me, a domestic abuse survivor, and my child who was a witness from the abuser who is now weaponizing the court system to further his agenda. They neglect local and out of state protection orders for my child and I saying, that even a convicted felon abuser has parental rights to see their child unsupervised.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Court assigned officials in JoCo are not all fit. There MUST be a way for the very people this system is intended to “benefit” to have feedback of providers. Checks and balances of providers should be visible and traceable. JoCo is very much pro-white man privilege. Men are rewarded for providing a fraction of effort (time and money) compared to the expectation of women. Women are held to such a very different standard. Any emotion is considered to make us unreliable and crazy when really we are so exhausted from the very system not listening and changing judges or changing court assigned officials to the highest paid attorney’s demands. Men are not held accountable in family courts at JoCo. They just aren’t.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I was bullied, slandered, abused, gaslit and lost custody not based on my character, finances, background, parenting skills, being safe, history of primary caregiver but because they had more family support than I did.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Exparte order for protection and my ex extended it to my daughter making her not available

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I now have no trust in the family court system. I fear every time I communicate with the other party that it will be used against me and twisted. I feel as though I’m one step away from being taken back into that nightmare every day over false allegations.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Instead of protecting my children, this system has enabled disruption, ignored critical concerns, and created outcomes that have damaged our family’s stability, trust, and long-term well-being. The family court system has fractured my family across three cases, replacing stability with conflict and allowing inconsistent decisions and broken processes to erode my children’s relationships, security, and trust.

— MEAGAN

Taken away mental, physical, financial from our family due to the racketeering.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I was granted full custody of my children and now paternal grandmother has manipulated the courts to believing they are better off with her. Decisions were made off of feelings and not actual law!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Have financial ruined us tore my business up black ball me from working and has moved my kid 4 hours away from me. Kept my husband and me separated . Our lives have been turned upside down

— ALICIA

Its broke me of my trust in people and has come between our kids and their father. Our kids come running to me and dont wanna leave (besides our youngest he's a mommas boy lol hes always happy to see mom). Its made me reevaluate every decision I make in fear of something being used to keep me from the kids again.

— ANTHONY

Protect the parent that emotionally harms and attempts to alienate our children because their hate for me is greater than their love for our children. Our counsel, the judge, nor case manager will enforce the court order allowing said parent to continue to violate without consequence, which allows ongoing emotional / financial harm and conflict with not only the other parent, but the children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This experience has broken our family but more importantly my children they ask what the point of life is and has made suicidal statements yet no one protects them and I'm not able to either as their mother.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Daily fear of being targeted and controlled in our abusers favor, with no way to defend myself or our son causing extream emotional issues and dissociation ruining my will to live.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

They have not cared about my sons medical conditions and to special needs. They did not look at evidence that one parent to the primary parents is taking care of all these medical needs into appointments. They only care about 5050 custody and not about looking at the fax. These poor children are being put in situations because of neglectful judges.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Substantial emotional, stigmatized and financial harm beyond repair..

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Separated all the kids from siblings , lost employment from multiple court cases even in the same week and haveing to miss work with mandatory contract hours. Judge refused via zoom ..lost transportation at one point couldnt afford the payment and we are currently going to loose our home that we own bc of lost wages .

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This whole thing has completely ripped my family apart. This neighbor has been a town bully and has financially drained our town and as financially drained my family he has 43 cases in the Cherokee County Court System and I'm the one with the injunction against me he is a professional career Criminal and people just tell me to keep taking it because nothing will ever change.

— CHRISTY

The court has enabled parental alienation and prioritized revenue over genuine reunification and my family's well-being. They have allowed the other household to undermine my children's physical and emotional health, and now the GAL and others are making claims that my ALL BOY, Avengers LEGO-loving son really wants to be a girl.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

"This system didn't just fail us, it chewed us up on a clerical mistake, treated fiction like fact, and called it justice while my family paid in time, money, and sanity. We weren't convicted by evidence, we were processed by indifference."

— SHAWN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I thought the family court system was designed to help families in time of need. I quickly learned that people of power that wear black robes forget what their actual job is. I have lost all faith in that system and will continue to stand against them until they earn my respect or actually do their job. I didn't choose divorce, but I had to accept it. What I will not accept is the fraudulent court system taking my time, money, and right to raise my children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Made me lose complete faith in the system . Favorite quote is the system isn't broken. It's rigged. It sure the he'll is. And it's hurting our children in so many ways that can't be measured by data alone.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They made records public so people could see what I did. Violation of privacy

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I didn't lose my children because of the truth. I lost years of their childhood while watching disputed evident be accepted, authentic evidence go unheard, and a system that seemed more committed to protecting itself then finding facts. My case deserves independent review, and so do countless others. If my experience reflects a broader pattern, then exposing it isn't about my case anymore. It's about protecting the next family.

— SAMANTHA

The hardest lesson I learned in family court was that patterns do not disappear just because they are ignored. When abuse is treated as an isolated incident, evidence becomes negotiable, opinions become powerful, and accountability becomes optional. That is when I realized the abuse had not disappeared. It had simply found another face.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The only power I truly have, is that over myself, and lucky for me, and you, we can choose peace NO MATTER WHAT ANYONE ELSE IS CHOOSING. Make your reality what you want it to be, once choice at a time.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The damage th8s caused has affected not only her, growing up thinking her mom didnt want her in ineumerable ways. The sadness my other kids felt in losing not only losing her in their lives, but also the betrayal of someone they thought was there to help us. My heartbreak i cannot begin to explain and carry to this day.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Sedgwick County, Kansas family court allowed parental alienation of the dad through extreme gross negligence. I suspect they are monetarily benefitting from the 'charity' that helped my lying ex without ANY evidence.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I am an adult, and in no way a victim. However, I have had to watch my child suffer at the hands of people that are in no way shape or form doing it for the "best interest of the child". Alienation, abduction, lack of education, psychological abuse, financial abuse, reactive abuse, and a situation where the child almost lost their life.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My family and life were ripped apart to keep USD 232 from consequences, and the lies told by multiple bad actors only impact me since there is no accountability for them. The only evidence available is the same evidence that would exonerate me but it would require unbiased court actors to look at it that way.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has torn my family apart, and created so much fear in my body that I now am on an antipsychotic medication just to be able to function in society because my PTSD and Depression/Anxiety are sometimes too much to handle.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has taken my life

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

After a long tedious divorce process that was finalized in 2023, I was thrilled to finally put it behind me. I asked for 50/50 custody and no child support (although the court enforced \$200/month from my ex). He was insidiously infiltrating our sons mind though and before I knew it, my own son was completely against me insisting to me during our time together he wants to live with his father and that I was clearly an incompetent mother, etc. In 2024 my ex filed a motion for full custody using outlandish allegations against me. Shortly after and without my knowledge he filed for emergency custody with no evidence or due process that same day the judge signed the order. It's been a year now since I've been able to see my son and have yet to have one hearing.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Every bit of joy in my life, is what they took from me. I get told all the time, I wish the old you would come back and sadly, that person no longer exists. My children have been robbed of so many memories that they could have made with not only myself, but their little cousins that they were so excited about, a very special bond my daughter and sister had since the day she was born (more than 10 yrs ago) my son of having a father to raise him and a relationship with their grandparent. It's forever changed my whole family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Used us for financial gain

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Broke an entire family apart, turned my family against me, forced me to have to fight for over two years to get my daughter back. I literally went to hell and back to get my daughter back, I got a different child back, emotionally, mentally, she was different and would never be the same. I would never be the same.

— JENNIFER

I lost a dearly beloved member of my family; my mother in lost the only grandchild she had. I suffered a loss of income that ultimately led to eviction from an apartment and the lies spread caused a significant hit to my reputation. I am now filing bankruptcy. I had to undergo forensic police questioning for the grossest of crimes - and that's a mental scar I cannot erase.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

174 full approved Kansas comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Kansas report comes from Kansas respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Kansas — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 272 Kansas families reporting here are not the universe of Kansas families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – August 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

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